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Industry connect



Acer aBeing One for IoT

locally or through the cloud). How is the company planning to attack the market? By enabling customers to implement smart IoT solutions through its 'aBeing' line-up of products, which will launch later this year.

The Acer aBeing One PC is aimed at developers who want to develop their own IoT solutions. It's designed to connect to smarthome and wearable products, and act as a hub that analyses incoming data from the devices. The 'abPBX Plus' is an advanced version of the aBeing One, offering high-end professional server grade communication services.

A key component propelling IoT's advancement in the near future is Acer's 'Open Platform Ecosystem', for which it has partnered with a range of companies to provide important turnkey solutions. For e.g. Acer's Open Platform incorporates 'Snappy Ubuntu Core' by Canonical to showcase a smart home surveillance solution. If an intruder were to break in, the motion-triggered camera would store video locally on an aBeing One, alert the homeowner on their smartphone and wait for further instructions. Similarly, Acer's BYOC hybrid cloud can be used for global fleet management (for a radio cab service, for example) through its mobile sensor hub devkit or smart healthcare solutions to be provided in a hospital scenario – all powered by the aBeing One at some level.

At Acer's headquarters, we're privy to smart thermostats, cloud-connected coffee makers, educational IoT devkits and syncing services that the company is working on – look at this video: <https://youtu.be/qx5jNjf7xnc>. It won't be an understatement to say that

Acer is investing heavily on cloud services and devices like the aBeing One to ensure that the recipe for IoT can come together effortlessly.

Another interesting Taiwanese company doing great work in the IoT domain is Advantech, whose motto is "Enabling an intelligent planet." It's a world leader in manufacturing and designing integrated embedded computing solutions that enable an enhanced level of automation through digitisation – at factories, on the road, in the building premises, at home, everywhere. And some of the demos we got to check out were actually quite amazing.

The company is known for building built-in self-sensing technology for IoT applications. It does this by manufacturing Box PCs that self-manage, self-protect and communicate seamlessly. Some of the things that Advantech specialises in are intelligent transportation,

smart retail, intelligent buildings, intelligent agriculture, and digital logistics and fleet management.

As a case study, Advantech highlighted its smart gantry solution implemented in Taiwan. It digitised 319 gantries, monitoring 6 million vehicles and carrying out 14 million transactions per day – completely removing the need for toll booths, as found on Indian roads. What makes this IoT solution so great? Due to seamless traffic movement, 22.5 million commuters' minutes were saved every day, leading to 60 million litres of reduced fuel consumption per year and a whopping 138,000 tonne of reduced carbon emissions per year.

Demonstrating its smart buildings IoT solution is Advantech's headquarters in Taipei, Taiwan, a living proof of concept. It has 20-metre high plant installations that are watered and tracked automatically without any

STARTUPS BETTING ON IOT

One of the major differences between startup ecosystems in India and Taiwan is simply comes down to manufacturing – while a majority of Indian startups try to be software solution-based (trying to push an app on to the customer), Taiwanese startups are (not surprisingly) more hardware-oriented. Products are physical there, whereas Indian startups are more competent in rolling out non-physical software. Here are three interesting hardware-based startup products from Taiwan:

- **Odin Laser Projection Mouse** – From Serafim Technologies comes a tiny, matchstick-sized laser mouse named after a Norse God. Extremely light and pocketable, Odin claims to be the world's first projection mouse. Meaning? It projects a beam of laser light onto the surface in front of it, allowing users to use any surface as a makeshift touchpad. And it detects pinch, zoom, two-fingered scroll motions too, along with a distinct right and left click action.
- **Jumpy Kids Smartwatch** – Loosely resembling a Qualcomm Toq smartwatch, Jumpy's a cute little smartwatch for kids with an animated character built in for kids to have fun, learn and play. It's unlike any other smartwatch, as it comes with a smart companion called "Jumpy" built into the device that helps kids run around, play and do other fun activities. It connects to the internet, allowing parents to keep track of their kids all the time. The company's current CEO, Jerry Chang, previously used to work for Foxconn.
- **Triton for divers** – Omnistar, another startup from Taiwan, is trying to make a big splash into the world of diving, by giving divers a Fitbit equivalent – something that tracks their dive in great depth, a process that currently has no consumer-friendly digital solution. The prototype device is still under wraps, but when ready, they plan to make recording and sharing dives as simple as sharing your jog or sprint through fitness apps on social media – that too in real time. Great news for IoT under the deep blue sea, eh?

